

Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 — Set up the agent, orchestration, and knowledge

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select Create → New agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Sales Pipeline Copilot
Description	Sellers and managers get pipeline insight, deal-health flags, and in-line CRM actions without leaving Teams.
Solution / Environment	Sales Solution · Default environment
Icon	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under Settings → Generative AI, choose how the agent decides what to do:

Generative Orchestration

Recommended — AI-led

- Agent reasons over user input and picks the right topic, tool, or knowledge
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks, and follow-ups naturally
- Best for varied user intent and exploratory questions
- Requires clear instructions, tool descriptions, and good knowledge

Classic Orchestration

Deterministic — trigger-led

- Topics fire on explicit trigger phrases you author
- Predictable flows, easier to audit step-by-step
- Best for tightly-scoped, regulated, or compliance-critical journeys
- Less forgiving of phrasing the author didn't anticipate

For this build we use Generative Orchestration so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for sales pipeline management.

3 Add Knowledge

Go to the Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File, then upload Sales_Pipeline_Data.xlsx. This file contains:

- Account details (account name, industry, region)
- Deal details (stage, amount, probability, product line, lead source)
- Ownership (account executive)
- Time data (expected close date, last activity date, days in stage)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

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Part 2 of 5 — Add instructions and a custom topic

4 Add Agent Instructions

Open Overview → Instructions and paste the following (these guide the model regardless of orchestration mode):

You are the Sales Pipeline Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Account executives reviewing their own deals.
- 2) Sales managers reviewing their team or region.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded opportunity data as your single source of truth.
- For analytical questions, calculate from the rows and explain method.
- For deal updates (stage, close date, next step), call the CRM tool.
- Flag stalled deals (no activity > 21 days) and slipping close dates.
- Never quote pipeline numbers across regions a user does not own.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Go to Topics → Add a topic → Create from description. Topics are reusable conversation flows the agent can call when intent matches.

Topic name: Update Deal Stage

Description: Lets a seller move an opportunity to a new stage and capture the next step in one conversational turn.

Trigger phrases (Generative Orchestration uses these as intent hints, Classic mode uses them as exact triggers):

- Move Cobalt Insurance to Negotiate
- Update the stage on deal OPP3015
- Set next step on the Northwind deal
- Progress my deal to Propose

Conversation steps:

- Identify the opportunity by name or ID (confirm if ambiguous)
- Ask for the new stage and the next step
- Look up current stage from knowledge and show the change
- Call the 'Update Opportunity' tool with the new values
- Confirm the update succeeded and offer to draft a follow-up email

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Part 3 of 5 — Add a tool and configure settings

6 Add a Tool

Tools let the agent take an action, not just answer. Go to Tools → Add a tool, and choose one of:

- Prebuilt connector (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow, etc.)
- Power Automate cloud flow (custom logic you author or already own)
- Custom HTTP request (any REST API your agent can reach)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP) server — for richer tool ecosystems

Tool name: Update Opportunity

Type: Dataverse connector (Update row on 'opportunity' table)

Description: Updates stage, close date, and next step on a CRM opportunity record.

Inputs the agent will collect or infer:

- Opportunity ID (string)
- New stage (Qualify / Discover / Propose / Negotiate / Closed Won / Closed Lost)
- Expected close date (date)
- Next step (string)

Outcome: Returns success and the new last-modified timestamp.

7 Configure Settings

Open the Settings cog (top right). Configure these four areas before you let real users near the agent:

- General — confirm name, description, and primary language
- Generative AI — orchestration mode and content moderation level (start at Medium)
- Authentication — use 'Authenticate with Microsoft' so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- Security — review DLP policy, enabled channels, and end-user authentication

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Part 4 of 5 — Evaluate, test, and publish to a channel

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Go to Analytics → Evaluations → New evaluation. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change.

Test set name: Sales Pipeline Copilot – Baseline v1
Approach: Pair each input prompt with an expected outcome.
Run the evaluation and review three scores per response:

- Groundedness – did the answer stay inside the knowledge?
- Relevance – did it actually address the question?
- Accuracy – did it match the expected outcome?

Sample evaluation items:

Input: Show me my pipeline by stage with weighted value
Expect: Calculates weighted value as amount × probability per row, sums by stage.

Input: Which deals haven't had activity in 21 days?
Expect: Returns rows where Last Activity Date is more than 21 days before today.

Input: Move Cobalt Insurance to Negotiate and set next step to 'Procurement review'
Expect: Triggers Update Deal Stage topic and calls Update Opportunity tool.

9 Test in the Test Pane

Use the Test pane (right side of the canvas) while you build. For each query, click Activity map to inspect what the agent did:

- Which topic, tool, or knowledge source fired (and in what order)
- Inputs the agent collected and outputs the tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your knowledge file
- Latency per step — useful when tuning multi-tool flows

10 Publish to a Channel

When you're happy, click Publish (top right). Then open Channels and enable the surfaces your users live in:

- Microsoft Teams — submit for admin approval, then pin to a team or chat
- Microsoft 365 Copilot — surface the agent inside Copilot Chat for licensed users
- Custom website — copy the embed snippet for an intranet page
- Other channels — Slack, Facebook, Telephony (Azure Communication Services)

Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval before users see the agent — plan for that lead time.

Try These Live

Part 5 of 5 — Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

Pipeline Health

Show pipeline by stage with total and weighted value.
What is the average days-in-stage by stage?

Risk & Slippage

List opportunities where Last Activity Date is more than 21 days ago.
Show deals with close date in the past that are still open.

In-line CRM Actions

Move the AlpenTech deal to Propose, close date next Friday.
Set next step on the Northwind Bank deal to 'Legal redline this week'.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Hunting through CRM dashboards
- Switching to CRM just to update a stage
- Manual weighted forecast roll-ups

With:

- ✓ Pipeline insight where sellers already work
- ✓ CRM updates in a single conversational turn
- ✓ Sharper forecast conversations with managers

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI — built once, used everywhere.

Tip for real-world use

Use Dataverse-native security roles so sellers see only their own book, managers see their team, and execs see the region. The Copilot Studio agent inherits those permissions automatically — no extra access logic to maintain.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Answer pipeline questions
- Update CRM in conversation
- Surface stalled and slipping deals
- Lift sellers' time-on-selling